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jury members were Sanjeev Krishan, Chairperson, PwC India; Bharat Puri, MD, Pidilite Industries; Amit Tandon, Founder & MD, Institutional Investor Advisory Services; Namita Thapar, Executive Director, Emcure Pharmaceuticals; Mathew Cyriac, Executive Chairman, Florintree Advisors; Manisha Girotra, CEO, Moelis India; and Amish Mehta, MD & CEO, Crisil.

This year we merged Unicorns and Soonicorns under the 'Startup of the Year (SOTY)' award. The data was sourced from Tracxn. Companies were shortlisted based on time taken to become a unicorn, latest valuations, and funding round in FY24 and after. Last year, we had introduced new categories including PSUs (renamed Bharat PSU Icon) and Clean Energy (renamed Green

Growth Visionary), Best Deals (renamed The Deal Maker) and The Glocal CEO. The Deal Maker contenders were shortlisted based on top M&A deals since January 2023. The data was sourced from Grant Thornton. For Glocal CEOs, nominations were considered from firms whose overseas income has been rising for the last three years against total income. To narrow the list, firms that got between 10% and 50% of business from abroad were considered. The jury accepted the suggestion of PwC to add one more jury award: Most Trusted Leader based on the strong and trustworthy public image built by years of ethical leadership. **BT**

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